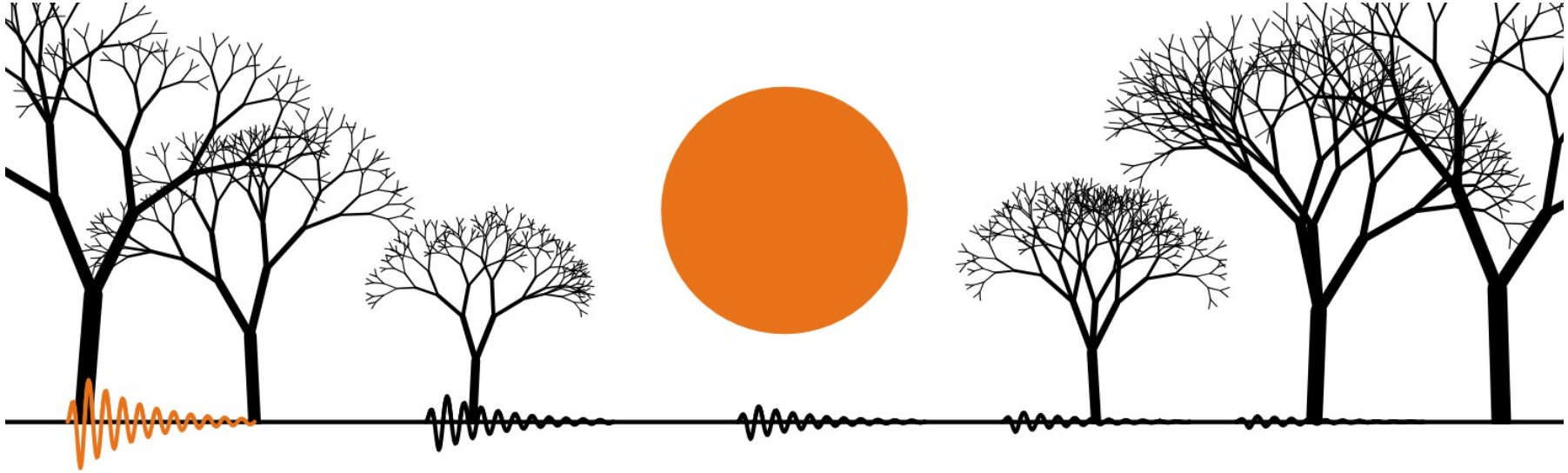
HUDSON BEAT



SPOOKY TUNES

Feat. the Halloween theme

DIGITAL MUSIC PRODUCTION · UNIT 6 · SCORING TO PICTURE IN LOGIC PRO

LISTEN FIRST

HALLOWEEN (MAIN TITLE)

John Carpenter

Teacher: play about 60 seconds from YouTube or Spotify.

- What makes it scary?
- What keeps repeating?
- Does it feel bright or dark?

LISTEN FOR THE SPACE

STRANGER THINGS (MAIN THEME)

Kyle Dixon & Michael Stein

Teacher: play about 60 seconds from YouTube or Spotify.

- Does it sound close, or far away?
- Can you hear echoes or a ‘room’ around the sound?
- What would it sound like totally dry?

WHAT MAKES MUSIC SPOOKY?

- Minor keys: darker than major
- Half steps: two notes that rub
- Space: reverb and delay make it feel big and far away
- Silence: the sound after it feels enormous

SPACE IS A SOUND

REVERB

a room, hall or cave around the sound

DELAY

an echo that repeats

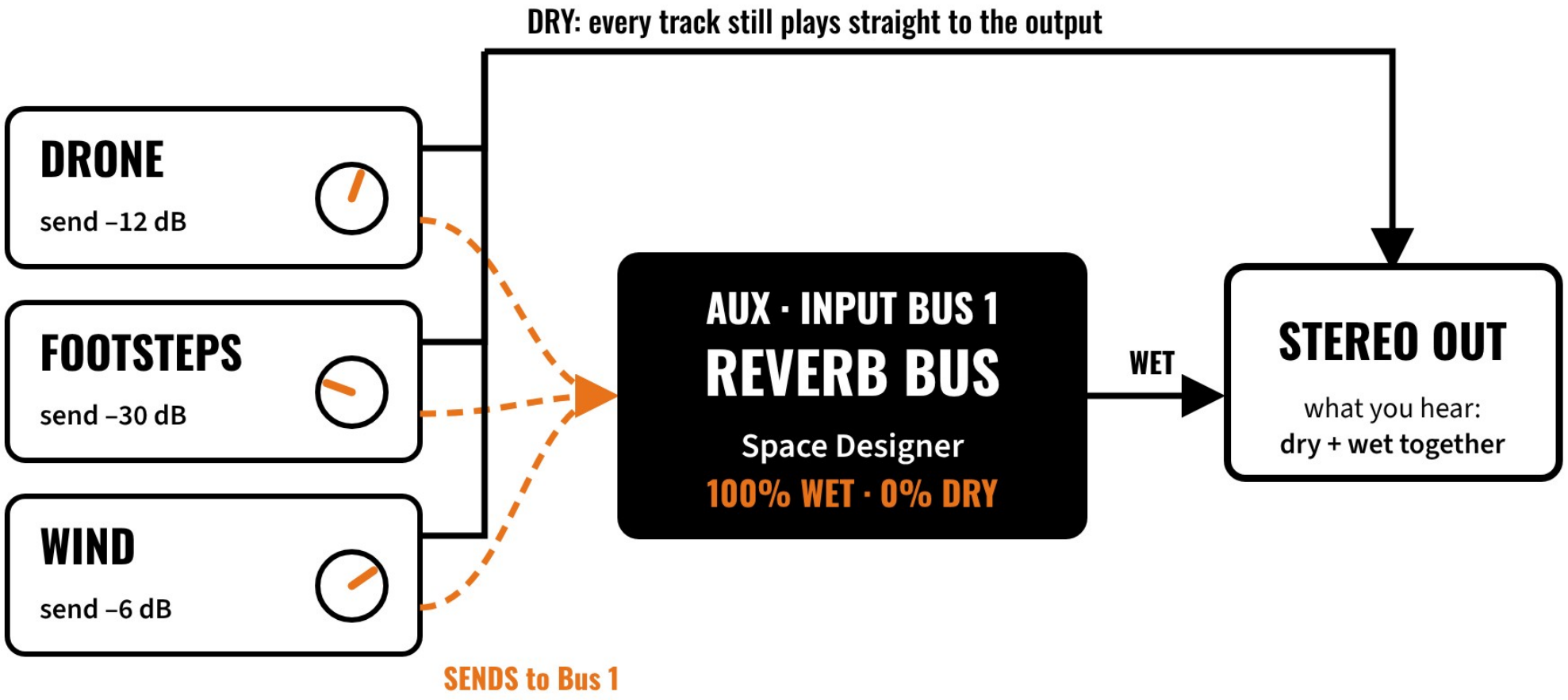
DRY

the original sound

WET

the effect only

WHAT THE HECK IS A BUS?



NEAR OR FAR?

- Same footstep: reverb send at –30 dB, then at –6 dB
- Which one sounds closer?
- Which one sounds farther away?
- Why not just put the reverb on every track?

WATCH ME: THE REVERB BUS

1. Mixer (X): on a track, click an empty Send slot, choose Bus 1
2. Logic creates an Aux channel. Name it REVERB BUS
3. On the Aux insert: Reverb › Space Designer, a large-space preset
4. In Space Designer: Dry 0%, Wet 100%
5. Raise the track’s send (start around –15 dB), then send 2 more tracks

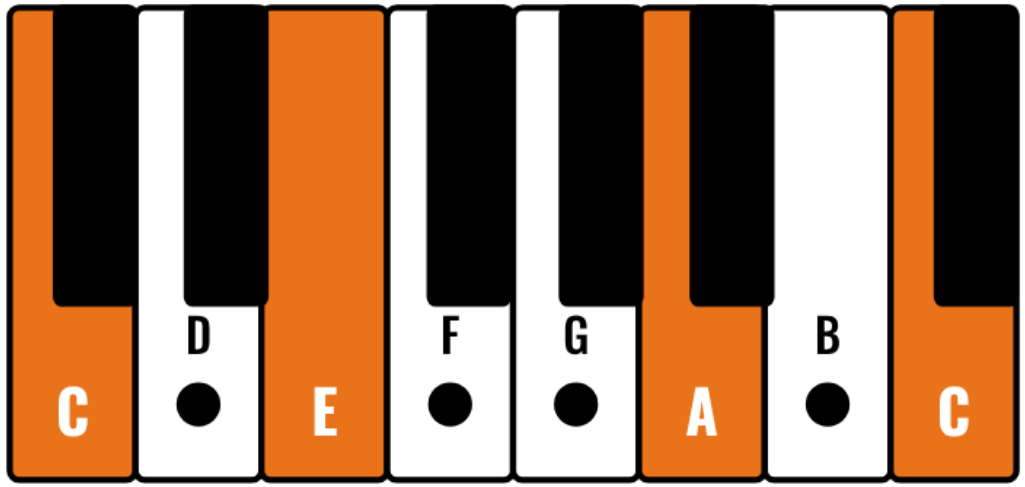
THEN THE DELAY BUS

1. On a track, click an empty Send slot, choose Bus 2
2. On the new Aux: Delay › Tape Delay. Name it DELAY BUS
3. Tape Delay: Dry 0%, Wet 100%
4. Send lower than the reverb: try –20 to –25 dB
5. Long time (600–900 ms) + more feedback = eerie

TWO MINOR KEYS

KEY 1 · A MINOR

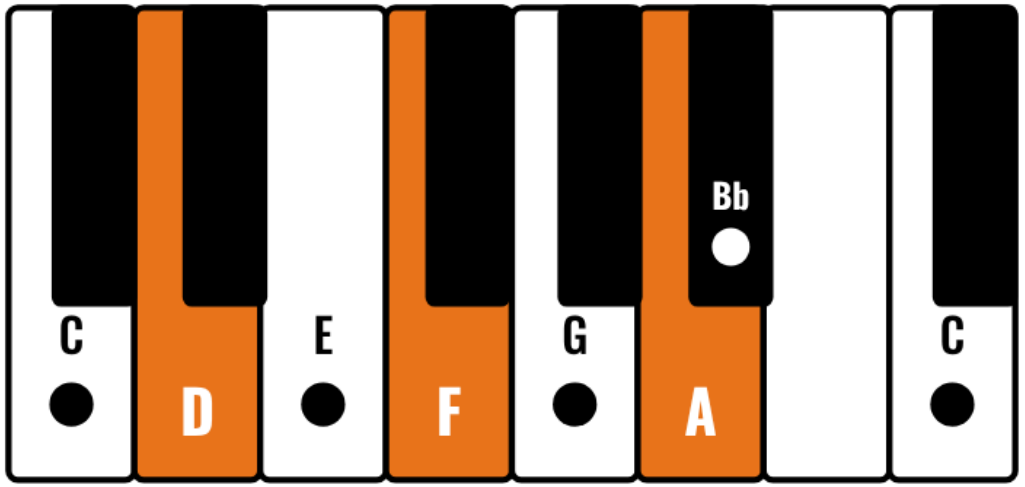
measures 1–16 · chord A C E



Scale: A B C D E F G

KEY 2 · D MINOR

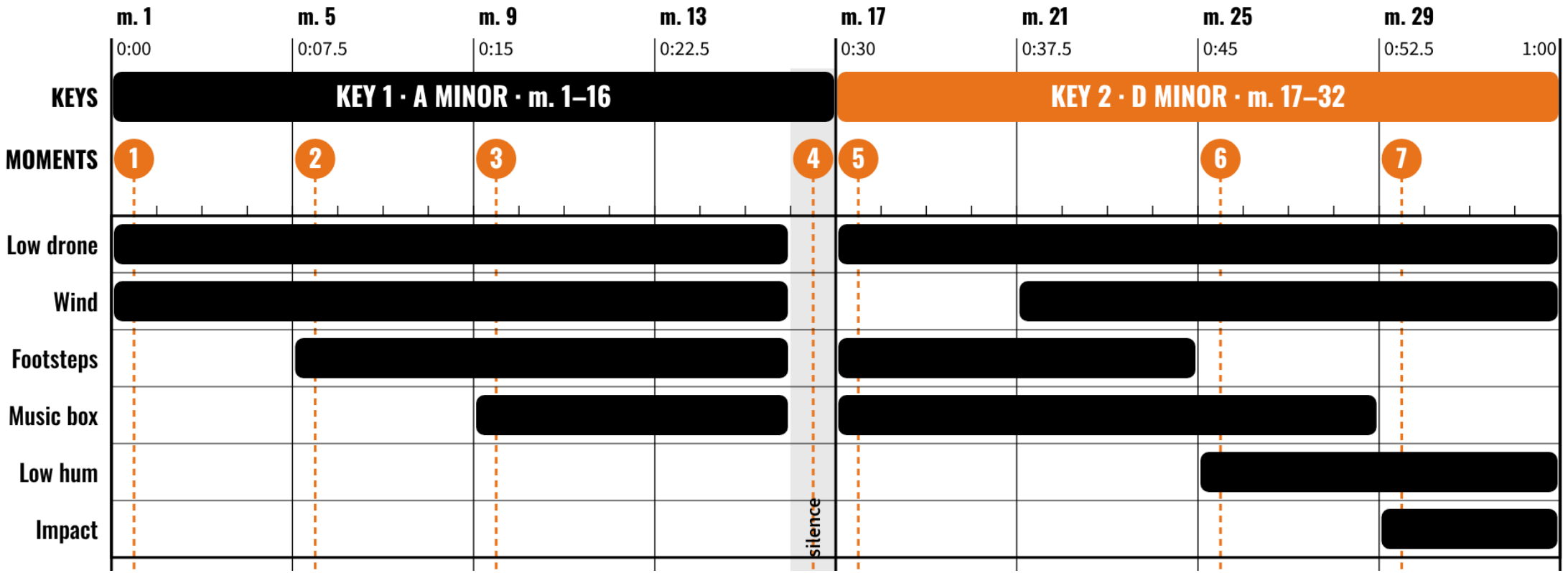
measures 17–32 · chord D F A



Scale: D E F G A Bb C

Orange = the first chord (root, third, fifth). Dots = the rest of the scale. Half steps rub: B–C and E–F.

WORKED EXAMPLE: SCORING THE WOODS



32 measures at 128 BPM = 60 seconds. Every 4 measures = 7.5 seconds. Numbers = moments in the video.

YOUR PROJECT: SPOOKY TUNES

- Score a one-minute woods video
- 32 measures in two minor keys
- A reverb bus and a delay bus
- 5+ sound sources: the Logic library, your own recording, a free download

THE STEPS

DAY 1	Bus demo · your reverb bus working
DAY 2	Delay bus · pick two minor keys · collect 5+ sounds
DAY 3	Import the video · markers · score key 1
DAY 4	Key 2 from measure 17 · rough mix
DAY 5	Final mix · reflection · submit
DAY 6	Present with the video

WHAT YOU TURN IN

- [ ] Reverb bus (Bus 1) and delay bus (Bus 2), both 100% wet
- [ ] 3+ tracks to reverb, 1+ to delay
- [ ] Two minor keys, 32 measures, the whole video
- [ ] 5+ sources: 1+ recording, 1+ free download
- [ ] MP3 + compressed .logicx, named Your Name – Spooky Tunes
- [ ] Reflection + three feedback questions

HOW IT'S SCORED

SOUND DESIGN & ATMOSPHERE	5 = Sounds from 5+ sources create an unsettling atmosphere that serves the video at every moment.	/ 5
COMPOSITION & PACING	5 = The music follows the picture, silence is a tool, and the key change lands on a moment.	/ 5
TECHNICAL SKILL / DAW USE	5 = Both buses set up correctly and used with intention; send levels vary to create depth.	/ 5
REVERB & DELAY AS MIX	5 = Near sounds dry, far sounds wet: a convincing sense of physical space.	/ 5
DOCUMENTATION & PRESENTATION	5 = On time, named correctly, and a confident presentation that explains the sound choices.	/ 5

TOTAL / 25

ONE LAST THING...

- Space is a sound.
- Silence is a tool.
- Celebrate the strange ones.

